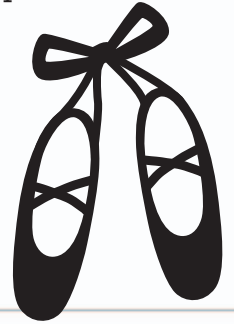




DANCER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Dancers use their bodies to perform routines to music, tell stories, and express ideas for the entertainment of audiences. They can work on stage as members of a dance company or theater group, or perform in films, TV shows, and music videos. Dancers spend years training to hone their skills and build up their fitness and flexibility. They usually specialize in one genre, such as ballet, jazz, or street dance.



SALARY

Junior in dance company ★★★★★
Experienced dancer ★★★☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Opportunities exist in dance, ballet, opera, and theater companies • Highly competitive industry • Many dancers are self-employed

CAREER PATHS

Most dancers begin their training in childhood, attending ballet classes or dance school. If you choose this career, you can continue training at vocational dance colleges or at colleges that offer undergraduate and graduate programs in dance. The physical demands and brevity of this career mean that most dancers have an additional line of work, possibly in dance teaching or therapy.

ASSISTANT In this role, you help out with classes at a dance school. You may lead students through exercises, help with choreography, or play accompanying music. Many dance students have their tuition reduced by working as part-time assistants.

GRADUATE An undergraduate degree in dance or in the performing arts may give your career a boost. You can also train in your chosen genre of dance at a private dance school and pass examinations by various accredited bodies.

DANCE NOTATOR Records dance moves in a score (a plan of a dance), using figures and graphic symbols. This allows ballets and other dance pieces to be recreated at a later date or by other companies.



DANCER Performance is an important but relatively small part of a dancer's life. You spend the bulk of your time practicing to maintain skills and fitness, preparing for auditions for new roles, or rehearsing.

